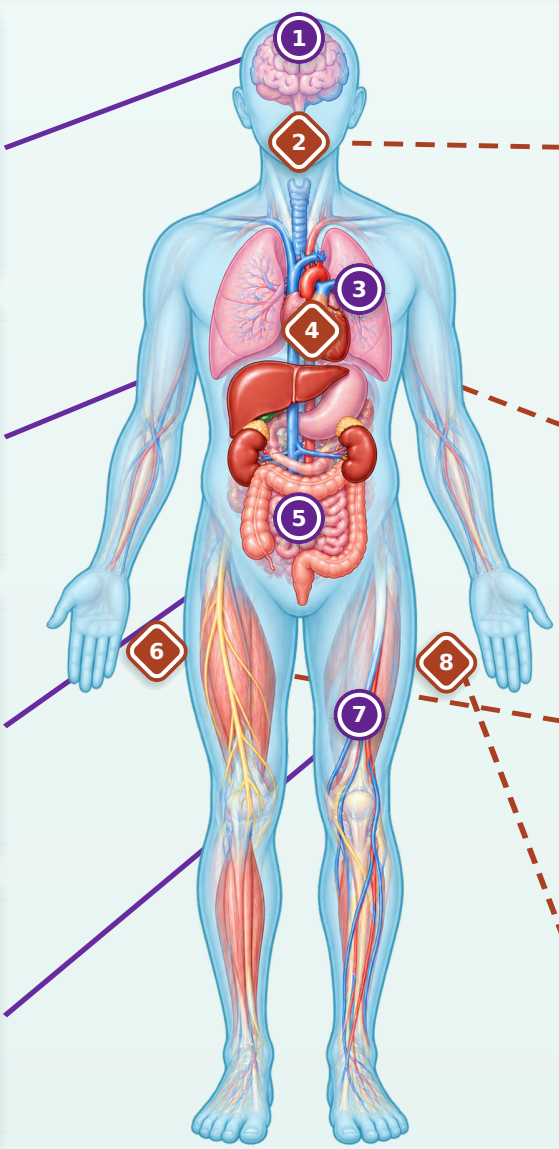
Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

Four AC treatments 14 days apart, followed 14 days after the last AC by 12 weekly paclitaxel doses, subject to recovery and review.

Draft — independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.



1 Hair / scalp

Chemotherapy

Hair loss or thinning varies; ask about support.

2 Mouth

Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

Painful ulcers or difficulty drinking need advice.

3 Breathing

Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt assessment.

4 Heart

Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

New chest pain, fainting or severe breathlessness needs urgent assessment.

5 Bowel

Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

Report diarrhoea early, especially with poor intake or dizziness.

6 Nerves / joints

Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

Report numbness, tingling or pain affecting daily activity.

7 Blood / infection

Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

Fever, shivers, unusual bleeding or sudden illness: call promptly.

8 Skin / liver symptoms

Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel

Report severe rash, blistering or yellow skin / eyes promptly.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Doxorubicin

- Low counts, infection and mouth ulcers
- Nausea, hair loss and fatigue
- Heart damage, sometimes delayed
- Severe tissue injury if the infusion leaks
- Rare later blood cancers

Cyclophosphamide

- Low counts and infection
- Nausea, vomiting and hair loss
- Bladder irritation / bleeding
- Fertility effects and menopause
- Rare later blood cancers

Paclitaxel

- Low blood counts and infection
- Numbness / tingling, sometimes lasting
- Hair loss, muscle or joint pain
- Infusion reaction
- Mouth, bowel, skin and nail effects

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Support for this phase

Use the separate AC and weekly-paclitaxel supportive scripts. G-CSF is required with dose-dense AC. Taxane premedicines are reviewed when the phase changes.

Bloods and cardiac checks

FBC, kidney/liver tests → Before each AC treatment → Before each weekly dose. Symptoms or risk determine extra checks.

Visits and practical support

Ask about travel, work, fertility, menopause, exercise and help at home. The team arranges and reviews clinical checks; the patient should not have to calculate the monitoring timetable.

Follow-up and bone health

If an aromatase inhibitor or ovarian suppression is prescribed, assess fracture risk and baseline DEXA as indicated. Repeat timing depends on the result, risk and bone treatment; it is not an automatic scan for everyone.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

CUH · MON–FRI 8AM–5PM

087 181 9645

Acute Oncology Service

CUH · WEEKENDS / BANK HOLIDAYS 9AM–5PM

021 4922000

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00485/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.